

CS23532 - COMPUTER NETWORKS LABORATORY

EXPERIMENT 3

Installation, Configuration, and Setup of Cisco Packet Tracer

1. AIM

To successfully download, install, configure, and set up Cisco Packet Tracer network simulation software on the host operating system, and to verify its operational workspace for designing, configuring, and troubleshooting network topologies.

2. PREREQUISITES

- Basic familiarity with computer operating systems (Windows / Linux / macOS).
- An active Cisco Networking Academy (SkillsForAll / NetAcad) user account for software authentication and access.
- Basic understanding of networking concepts (IP addresses, switches, routers, and host workstations).
- Administrative privileges on the target host computer to perform software installation.

3. APPARATUS / HARDWARE & SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS

Component	Minimum Requirement	Recommended Specifications
Processor (CPU)	x86 64-bit compatible processor (1.5 GHz or higher)	Intel Core i5 / AMD Ryzen 5 or higher (2.0 GHz+)
System Memory (RAM)	4 GB RAM	8 GB RAM or higher
Storage Space	1.5 GB available disk space	3.0 GB available SSD storage space
Display Resolution	1024 x 768 resolution	1920 x 1080 (Full HD) resolution
Operating System	Microsoft Windows 10/11 (64-bit), Ubuntu Linux, or macOS	Windows 11 (64-bit) or latest Ubuntu LTS

**Software
Executable**

Cisco Packet Tracer Standalone
Installer (64-bit executable file)

Cisco Packet Tracer Standalone
Installer (64-bit executable file)

4. STEP-BY-STEP PROCEDURE

Step 1: Downloading the Installer Package

1. Open a web browser and navigate to the official Cisco Networking Academy portal or SkillsForAll website.
2. Log in using your registered Cisco NetAcad / SkillsForAll credentials.
3. Navigate to the **Resources** tab and select **Download Packet Tracer**.
4. Select the appropriate installer executable for your host operating system (e.g., 64-bit Windows setup executable).
5. Save the installer file to your host computer's local storage.

Cisco
Networking
Academy

Cisco Packet Tracer Resources

Download

Cisco Packet Tracer software is available to download at no cost for Cisco Networking Academy educators and learners.

Cisco Packet Tracer is used for lab activities in many networking, IoT and cybersecurity courses. To complete the activities, users will need to download and install Cisco Packet Tracer on their computer. Login is required to download the application.

We regularly maintain the Cisco Packet Tracer software with routine security updates and new features. We highly encourage users to keep up-to-date with the latest version. Some courses or lab activities may require an upgrade to the latest version.

Learners should check with their instructor on which software version to use for their class.

[Download](#)

From the link above, you can download the latest version of Cisco Packet Tracer (version 9.0.0), which includes all the newest features and improvements. We strongly recommend using the most recent version. However, if you have a specific need, you can download a previous version of the software from the links below. Please note that version 8.2.2 will be available for download only until the end of January 2026.

- [Cisco Packet Tracer 8.2.2 MacOS 64bit](#)
- [Cisco Packet Tracer 8.2.2 Ubuntu 64bit](#)
- [Cisco Packet Tracer 8.2.2 Windows 64bit](#)

Step 2: Executing the Software Installation Wizard

1. Locate the downloaded installer file (e.g., `CiscoPacketTracer822_64bit_setup.exe`) and right-click to select **Run as Administrator**.
2. When the License Agreement dialog appears, read the terms, select **I accept the agreement**, and click **Next**.
3. Specify the target installation directory (default path: `C:\Program Files\Cisco Packet Tracer`) and click **Next**.

4. Choose the Start Menu folder option and ensure the check box for **Create a desktop shortcut** is enabled. Click **Next**.
5. Review the configuration summary and click **Install** to initiate the extraction and installation process.
6. Once file extraction completes, check the option **Launch Cisco Packet Tracer** and click **Finish**.

Cisco Packet Tracer Resources

Cisco Packet Tracer is used for lab simulations. You need to download and install Cisco Packet Tracer on your computer.

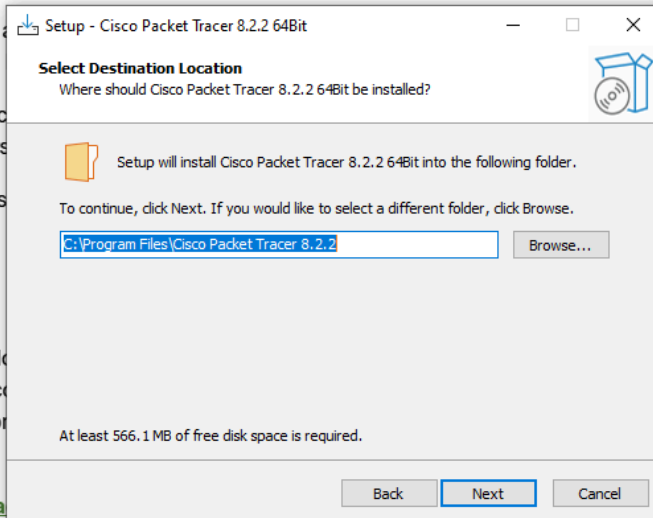
We regularly maintain the Cisco Packet Tracer software to keep up-to-date with the latest versions.

Learners should check with their instructor for the latest version.

[Download](#)

From the link above, you can download the latest version and improvements. We strongly recommend downloading the previous version of the software from January 2026.

- [Cisco Packet Tracer 8.2.2 Mac 64bit](#)
- [Cisco Packet Tracer 8.2.2 Ubuntu 64bit](#)
- [Cisco Packet Tracer 8.2.2 Windows 64bit](#)



Cisco Packet Tracer Resources

Cisco Packet Tracer is used for lab activities. You need to download and install Cisco Packet Tracer.

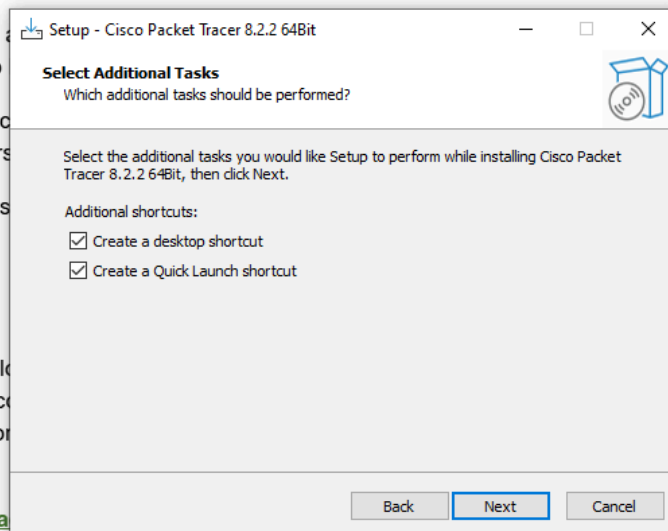
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Complete the activities, application.

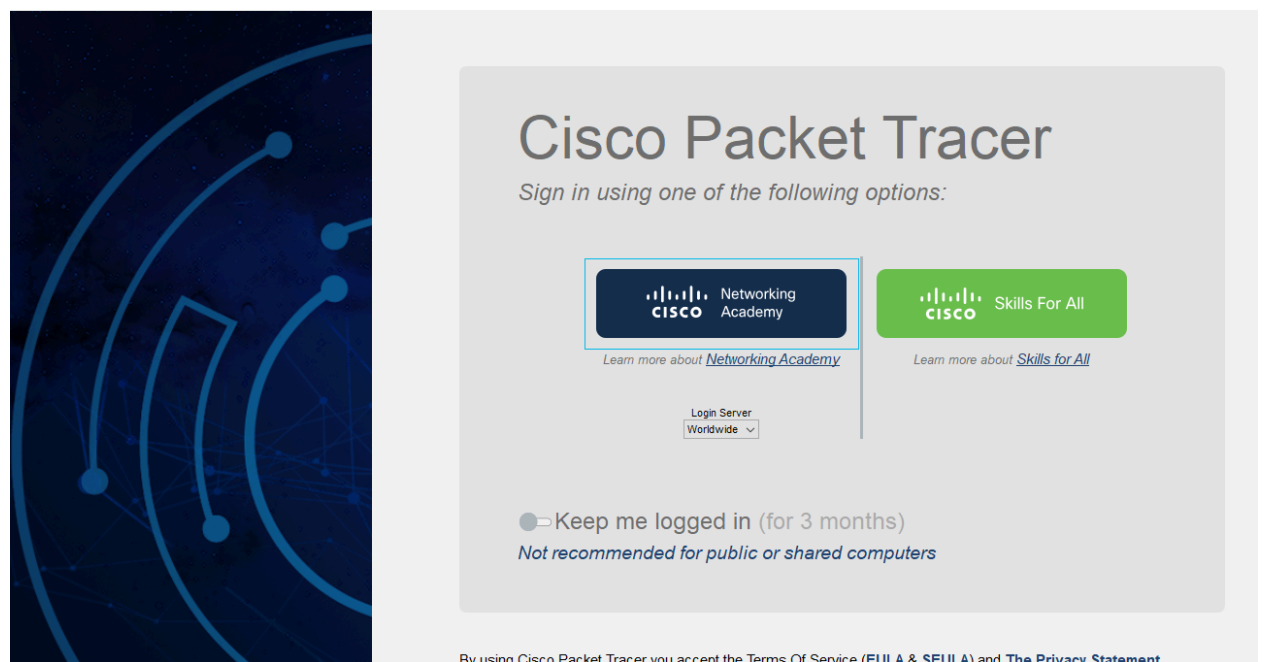
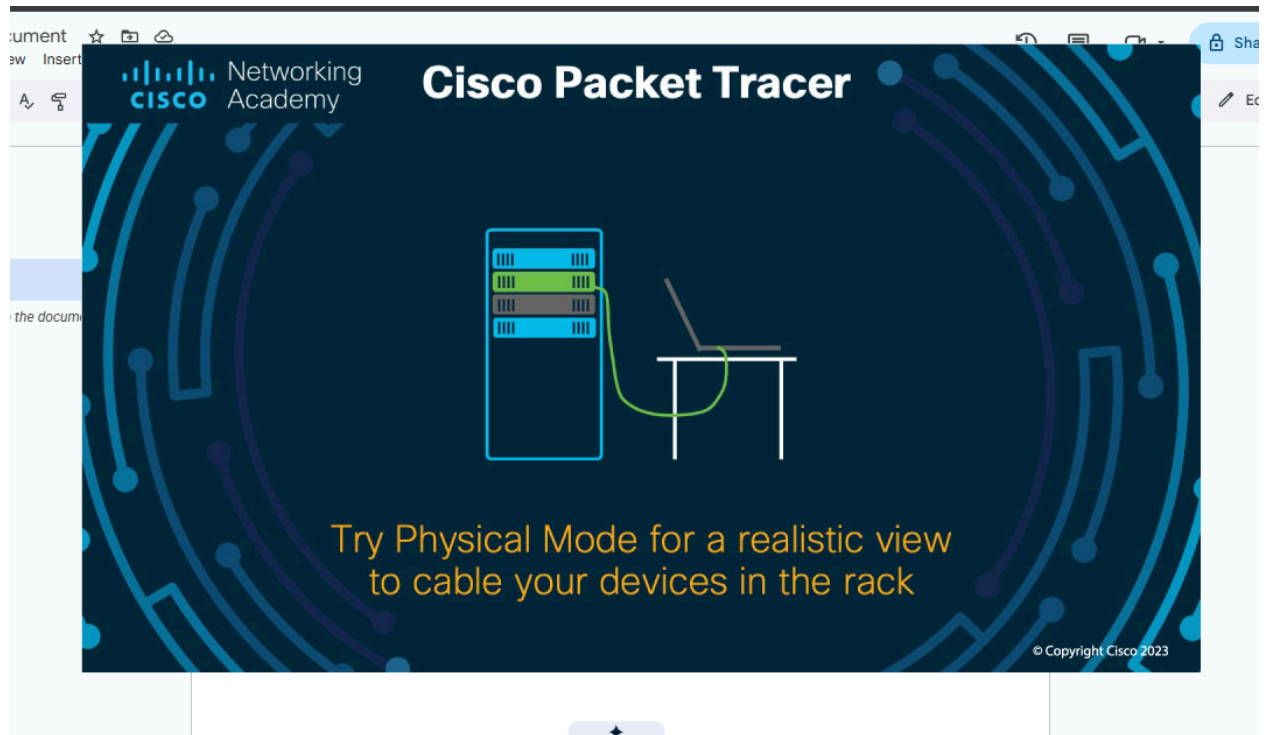
We highly encourage the latest version.

includes all the new features. If you have a specific need, you can download only until January 2026.

Get Started

Step 3: Initial Setup & Account Authentication

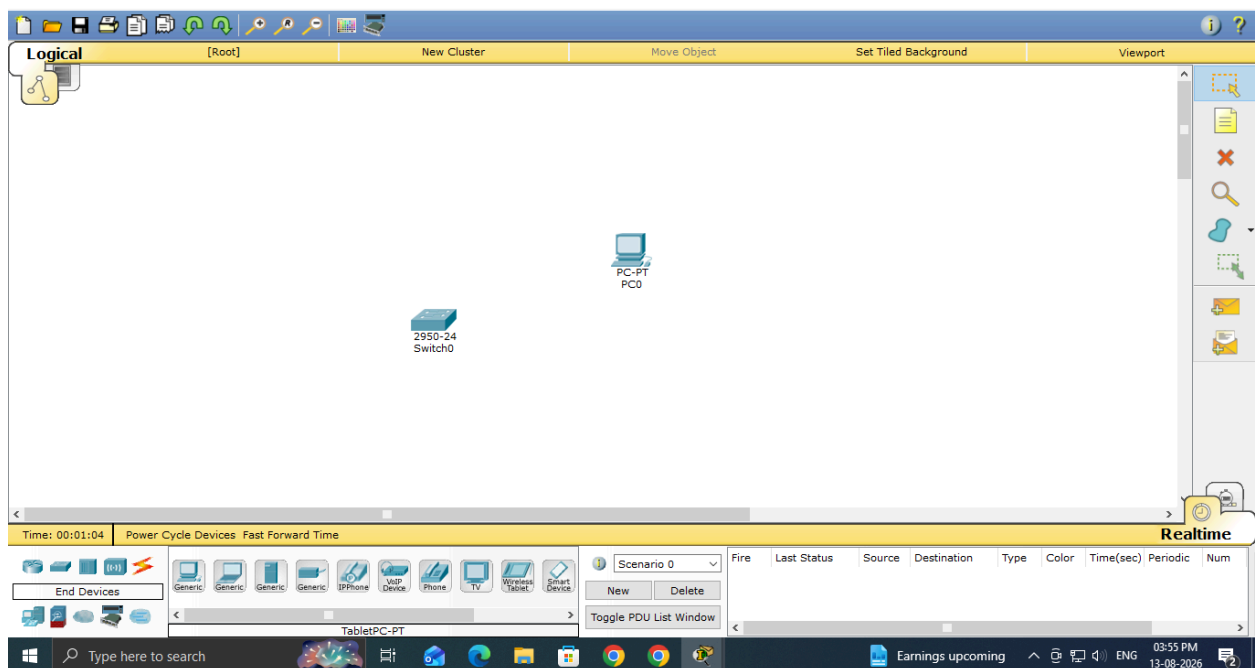
1. Upon initial launch, if prompted by Windows Defender Firewall, grant network access privileges for private networks.
2. When the Cisco Packet Tracer Login screen displays, enter your Cisco Networking Academy / SkillsForAll account credentials.
3. Check the **Keep me logged in** option to avoid re-authentication during future laboratory sessions.



Step 4: Environment Verification & Basic Workplace Setup

1. Verify that the primary workspace components load correctly:
 - **Logical Workspace:** Central canvas for placing device icons.

- **Bottom Device Toolbar:** Contains Routers, Switches, End Devices, Cables, and Security Appliances.
 - **Top Menu & Action Bar:** Selection, Inspection, Delete, and Note tools.
2. Perform a basic functionality test:
- Drag two PC endpoints (**End Devices** → **PC**) onto the logical canvas.
 - Connect both PCs using a Copper Straight-Through or Auto-Connect Cable.
 - Click on each PC to assign static IP addresses (e.g., 192.168.1.1 and 192.168.1.2).
 - Open the Command Prompt interface on PC0 and issue a ping 192.168.1.2 command to confirm connectivity.



5. RESULT

Cisco Packet Tracer was successfully downloaded, installed, and configured on the host workstation. The application environment was authenticated via Cisco NetAcad credentials, and basic end-to-end network communication between host devices was successfully simulated and verified in the logical workspace.